



Cavani, PSG started winning domestic trophies consistently over the next decade. It won 36 trophies, including 11 of the 13 Ligue 1 titles.

For fans outside France with limited football knowledge, PSG was the only club that mattered. But without much resistance, the crown grew hollow. The owners wanted more — the pinnacle of European club football: the Champions League.

Meetings were held, new managers were signed, and transfer records were shattered.

The existing stars, Ibrahimovic and Cavani, were replaced by bigger names — Neymar, the most expensive transfer of all time (€222 million), and Kylian Mbappe, the second-most expensive transfer to date at €180 million.

The moves eventually bore fruit: PSG reached the UCL final for the first time in 2020, where it lost to Bayern Munich. Defeat festered into discord. Coaches came and went,

legends departed, yet PSG clung to its Galácticos doctrine.

Serial UCL winner Sergio Ramos joined in 2021, and within a month, Lionel Messi completed the holy trinity of modern-day PSG attack, along with Neymar and Mbappe. But only two Round of 16 exits followed. PSG remained the perpetual dreamer, the Sisyphus of the football world, pushing the boulder uphill.

The Enrique project

For solutions, the club signed Enrique as manager, someone who had won the treble with Barcelona nearly a decade ago. His philosophy was clear: dismantle the cult of individualism and forge a collective ethos with those desperate to prove their worth. So much so that the biggest transfer under him, Randal Kolo Muani (from Eintracht Frankfurt for €95 million), was loaned to Juventus because he fell out of Enrique's plans.

Goals galore: A brace by Desire Doue and goals by Achraf Hakimi, Khvicha Kvaratskhelia and Senny Mayulu helped PSG win its first UCL title. AFP

